



Minecraft YouTuber exploits AI
Mojang recently updated Minecraft but one YouTuber decides to use AI to bring more ideas to life. <https://digit.in/sep22-15>



Cyberpunk's new anime trailer
It shows off violence, romance, and more giving a closer look at the upcoming series. <https://digit.in/sep22-16>

How will 5G rollout impact Indians?



Lt. Gen. Dr. S.P. Kochhar, Director General, COAI

The next revolution?

Jayesh Shinde | jayesh@digit.in

W

e spoke to Lt. Gen. Dr. S.P. Kochhar, Director General, COAI, immediately after India's 5G spectrum

auction to get some insights about the Indian telecommunications industry and its 5G rollout roadmap. We also asked him the age-old question about EMF radiation fears of 5G frequency bands, and what steps the industry is taking to safeguard 5G networks in terms of national security. Edited excerpts from our interview follow:

Q Is 5G still safe? Is 5G going to add to people's worries from a health and safety perspective in India?

A This question should now be put to rest because the Indian IT Minister himself has gone on record saying that 5G networks are very safe. Several international studies done on this topic say that the EMF emanating out of mobile towers are non-ionizing, and hence safe for human beings. Even if you don't know all this, just look at birds who go and nest on these towers,

they build their nests and nurture their young ones, and nothing happens to them. So how can it be harmful to humans?

This is just a myth propagated by people who are talking about unsafe 5G because they have vested interests to serve, nothing else. But as far as scientific evidence is concerned, there is nothing to suggest that 5G networks are unsafe.

Q How will 5G services roll-out across India over the next few months and years?

A What is emerging is there'll be two types of 5G rollouts happening across India. One will be to cater to the demands from metros. The second rollout would be related to enterprise services that will open up new markets, and use cases, and that's where the maximum 5G revenue is going to be generated from.

You also need to understand that India is a very price sensitive market. There's a very good likelihood of 5G tariffs to go up from existing data rates. Expecting a common citizen to really see any benefit and pay more for a new connection or having to buy a new

phone to get a 5G connection is going to be difficult. Don't get me wrong, there will be lots of people who will sign-up for 5G services from day one, but the scale will not be comparable to people who are already subscribed to 4G.

Telecom operators will have to mix and match where they deliver the promise of 5G speed and coverage to 5G enthusiasts no matter what. Also for existing 4G users or people migrating from 2G or 3G. In some places non standalone 5G will also work, while some places will have only standalone 5G deployments, with network slicing and other segmentation depending on the use case.

Q How do you react to social media memes claiming with 5G launch Indians will finally see promised 4G network speeds?

A There are multiple factors that impact network speeds, and it's harsh to blame only the telecom operators for it. Before I joined COAI, I also used to think that telcos are not doing their job properly. But after spending two years in the ecosystem, I realised that there are environmental factors in play